

Daily Need to Know

Tuesday, 25 August 2026 · Pre-market brief

Coverage window, capture method and edition notes are at the back, in section 16.

1 Market snapshot — the close, and where it is trading now

All live levels captured 06:07:18–06:07:20 GMT+8 (18:07 ET Mon) — a 2-second window. ▲ up ▼ down ◆ flat/mixed.

ASSET	LAST	CHANGE	NOTE
US CASH EQUITIES — SETTLED 16:00 ET MONDAY (04:00 GMT+8), 2H 07M OLD			
S&P 500	7,652.86	▼ 21.51 · −0.28%	Range 7,638.17–7,670.30, a 32-point day. Closed mid-range, not on the low. Sits 0.47% above Hedgeye's 7,617 floor — the lower third of the band.
Nasdaq Composite	25,980.19	▼ 200.26 · −0.77%	Closed in the bottom third of a 199-point range. Just 0.30% above the 25,903 Hedgeye floor — the tightest of any equity band.
Dow Jones Industrials	53,417.16	▲ 140.15 · +0.26%	Closed at 63% of range. 103bp of spread over the Nasdaq — the widest Dow-over-Nasdaq day of the month.
Russell 2000	2,995.08	▼ 22.79 · −0.76%	Closed at just 14% of its range — the only major index that finished near its low, and back below 3,000 .
Philadelphia SOX	11,423.16	▼ 317.22 · −2.70%	The day's whole story. Low 11,263.34; closed 64% of range, so it did bounce. NYSE Composite finished −0.008% — the broad tape did not move at all.
US INDEX FUTURES — LIVE LEVEL, 7 MINUTES INTO THE NEW GLOBEX SESSION; CHANGE AND RANGE ARE MONDAY'S DAY SESSION			
E-mini S&P (ES)	7,669.75	▼ 21.50 · −0.28%	Basis to cash +16.89 , a normal carry. 1,044,788 lots. Range 7,655–7,703.25.
E-mini Nasdaq (NQ)	29,105.75	▼ 282.00 · −0.96%	518,759 lots. Traded a 534-point range and settled in the lower quarter of it.
E-mini Dow (YM)	53,489	▲ 136 · +0.26%	57,329 lots. The only green equity future.
E-mini Russell (RTY)	3,001.60	▼ 20.50 · −0.68%	114,971 lots. Futures are above 3,000 while cash closed below it — the round number is genuinely contested.
US TREASURY CASH YIELDS — LIVE			
US 10-year	4.700%	▼ 3.6bp	Range 4.680–4.724%. Sits exactly mid-band on Hedgeye's 4.65–4.75% — the single most neutral mark in the document.
US 30-year	5.227%	▼ 4.9bp	The long end led the rally. 30s10s at 52.7bp .
US 5-year	4.406%	▼ 2.2bp	Belly moved less than the long end — a bull-flattening day, not a duration panic.
US 13-week bill	3.798%	▼ 1.0bp	Anchored. 10s2s at 46.2bp with the 2-year at 4.238%, which Hedgeye flipped to bullish TREND last week.
ENERGY — FRONT-MONTH FUTURES, LIVE LEVEL; CHANGE AND RANGE ARE MONDAY'S SESSION			
WTI crude	\$85.01	▼ 2.05 · −2.36%	The inconvenient number. Crude fell 2.4% on the day Washington announced its widest Iran sanctions package yet. Range 84.36–86.57.
Brent crude	\$92.17	▼ 2.22 · −2.35%	Brent-WTI spread \$7.16 . Both benchmarks fell in near-lockstep, so this was length being cut, not a grade story.
Natural gas	\$2.782	▲ 0.009 · +0.33%	The only green energy contract. Sits at 68% of a band Hedgeye calls bearish TREND — pressing the wrong end of its own signal.
RBOB gasoline	\$2.9688	▼ 0.078 · −2.56%	Fell harder than crude. The crack narrowed into the back end of driving season.
METALS — SPOT, LIVE; CHANGE COVERS ONLY THE 67 MINUTES SINCE THE 17:00 ET ROLL AND IS NOISE			
Gold (spot)	\$4,657.67	◆ +0.13% (67min)	Monday's real move was +0.37% on futures and +0.79% on GLD. Spot sits at 87.5% of Hedgeye's 4,403–4,694 band — just 0.78% below the ceiling.
Silver (spot)	\$69.048	◆ +0.13% (67min)	Silver futures fell −1.35% and SLV −0.83% on Monday — silver did not follow gold. At 72% of its 64–71 band.
Copper (spot)	\$6.5693	◆ −0.00% (67min)	Futures +0.27%. At 36.8% of the 6.47–6.74 band — the weakest position of the three metals despite copper miners' +11% week.
FX — LIVE; CHANGE COVERS THE 67 MINUTES SINCE THE 17:00 ET ROLL			
Dollar index (DXY)	98.983	◆ +0.15%	At 39.9% of Hedgeye's 98.40–99.86 bearish band. Short-dollar is the house's core position and it is not yet under threat.
USD/JPY	159.076	◆ −0.00%	An 8.8-pip range in 67 minutes — genuinely inert. 159 is the level Asia will trade around.
USD/KRW	1,382.45	▼ 0.21%	Won firmer, +2.3% last week — while the KOSPI fell 3.1%. Currency and equity market are telling opposite stories about Korea.
VOLATILITY AND CRYPTO — VIX SETTLED WITH CASH; CRYPTO CONTINUOUS, 22 HOURS OF SESSION			

ASSET	LAST	CHANGE	NOTE
VIX	15.84	▲ 0.70 · +4.62%	A 4.6% vol bid on a 0.28% index decline is disproportionate. Sits at 82% of a 13.79–16.28 band Hedgeye labels bearish TREND.
Bitcoin	\$78,949.53	▲ 1,245.59 · +1.60%	Printed a high of \$79,976.16 — twenty-four dollars short of \$80,000 — then failed. Up roughly 24% on the week off the ~\$62,700 mid-August low.

Colour key: green ▲ higher; red ▼ lower; amber ♦ flat or measured over a window too short to be meaningful. Reconciliation: this capture is TradingView-single-sourced — Yahoo Finance rate-limited the run and returned nothing, so the script's automatic cross-check produced no matched pairs. The three headline index closes were verified by hand against press wire reporting and agree exactly; see section 18. Yields are cash constant-maturity, not futures-implied. Metals bands are measured on spot, which is the series Hedgeye names; measuring gold on futures instead would have placed it outside its band rather than at 87.5% of it.

TL;DR

The index fell 0.28% and nothing happened to the market. The NYSE Composite closed unchanged to four decimal places, equal-weight beat cap-weight by 41bp, and eight of eleven sectors rose. What fell was memory: **Micron –5.8%, SanDisk –6.5%, Western Digital –5.2%**, dragging the SOX down 2.7% after Samsung's capital-return plan disappointed in Seoul and the KOSPI broke down 3.1%. Nvidia's seventh consecutive decline — its first such run since September 2022 — lands two days before it reports. Underneath, the AI-hardware complex has already been repriced far harder than the index admits: **Oracle is 58.8% below its 52-week high, Western Digital 45.6%, Intel 38.7%, SanDisk 36.6%**, with the S&P a fraction off its own. Money went to staples (+1.70%), financials (+1.29%) and utilities (+1.05%) — the last of which is Hedgeye's only sector short. Treasuries bull-flattened, crude fell 2.4% into the widest Iran sanctions package yet announced, and gold pressed to within 0.78% of its risk-range ceiling. Asia opens into a semiconductor problem, not an equity problem.

2 The big picture — what it means

This was a sector event wearing an index costume. The S&P lost 21.51 points and the Nasdaq 200.26, but the NYSE Composite closed at 24,726.65, down 2.03 points — a change of –0.008%. Equal-weight RSP rose 0.117% while cap-weighted SPY fell 0.294%, a 41bp gap in favour of the average stock. Eight of the eleven SPDR sectors closed higher. When the median stock rises and the index falls, the index is not the information; the concentration is.

The specific thing that broke was memory, and it broke in Seoul before it broke in New York. Samsung's record shareholder-return plan landed below expectations, its shares fell roughly 9%, and the KOSPI closed down 3.124% at 6,696.97 — through the 6,796 level Hedgeye had flagged as its immediate-term TRADE line, and 26.6% below its cycle peak. That transmitted directly: **Micron –5.83%, SanDisk –6.45%, Western Digital –5.24%**. The SOX fell 317 points. This is a capital-returns disappointment in a crowded trade, not a demand signal, and it is worth keeping those two things separate.

The drawdowns already sitting inside the AI complex are the most under-reported fact in this brief. With the S&P within a rounding error of its highs, Oracle trades **58.8%** below its 52-week high, Western Digital **45.6%** below, Intel **38.7%**, SanDisk **36.6%**, Applied Materials **34.5%**, Meta **29.3%**, Micron **27.5%** and Broadcom **27.5%**. Nvidia itself is 11.9% off. A bear market has already been fought and largely lost inside the infrastructure names while the headline index made new highs on the strength of everything else. Anyone describing Monday as the start of an AI unwind is roughly a quarter late.

Nvidia's tape is doing something it has not done in four years. Monday was a seventh consecutive decline, the first such streak since September 2022, on 134.7m shares against a ten-day average of 100.4m — 34% above normal. It closed at \$208.48, a \$5.045tn capitalisation, and it reports on Wednesday. A stock that has fallen seven straight sessions into a binary event on rising volume is not being sold by people who expect a bad number; it is being de-risked by people who cannot size the reaction. Hedgeye's own desk says the same thing in plainer words — no position in Korea or DRAM into the print, on the view that choosing no position is a position.

Bonds contradicted the risk-off reading. The 30-year fell 4.9bp, the 10-year 3.6bp and the 5-year 2.2bp — a bull-flattening led by the long end, with the 13-week bill barely moving and MOVE at 73.98, still under 75. If Monday had been a genuine growth scare, the front end would have led. It did not. The curve at 46.2bp of 10s2s is doing nothing more dramatic than absorbing a bid for duration on a day when equity money left one sector.

Crude falling 2.36% on the day the United States announced its widest Iran sanctions package to date is the number to sit with. Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent unveiled "Operation Economic Outcast" — expanded secondary sanctions across digital assets, gold, aviation, technology and shipping. WTI settled \$85.01, Brent \$92.17, RBOB –2.56%. Either the market has concluded the barrels remain priced in, or it read the announcement as a substitute for military action rather than a prelude to it. Hedgeye's own Polymarket read supports the second: odds of a US invasion before 2027 sit at their lows around 17%, while the odds of the Strait of Hormuz normalising by December have fallen toward 34%. Sanctions are the "no war, no deal" outcome, and oil sold the war premium.

Gold is the cleanest expression of the current regime and it is running out of band. Spot at \$4,657.67 sits 87.5% of the way through Hedgeye's \$4,403–\$4,694 risk range, 0.78% from the ceiling, after a 5.3% week. The dollar carries a –0.70 fifteen-day correlation to gold and –0.89 to bitcoin, and the dollar remains in bearish TREND at 39.9% of its own band. That is a coherent trade. It is also a trade with very little room left before the signal itself needs to move.

3 Rates, currencies & commodities

- **Bull flattener, led by the long bond.** 30-year −4.9bp to 5.227%, 10-year −3.6bp to 4.700%, 5-year −2.2bp to 4.406%, 2-year −0.2bp to 4.238%, 13-week bill −1.0bp to 3.798%. 10s2s 46.2bp, 30s10s 52.7bp. The 10-year finished precisely mid-band on Hedgeye's 4.65–4.75%, which is as close to a genuinely undecided mark as this document contains.
- **Bond volatility stayed asleep while equity volatility woke up.** MOVE at 73.98, up 0.79% and still below the 75 line Hedgeye watches; VIX up 4.62% to 15.84. Cross-asset volatility is diverging, and the equity move is the outlier.
- **The dollar did nothing and that is the point.** DXY 98.983, at 39.9% of a bearish-TREND band, after falling 0.87% on Friday. EUR/USD 1.16648 (+0.79% last week, +1.5% on the month), GBP/USD 1.36326, AUD/USD 0.71492, USD/CNH 6.72089. Short-dollar remains the house's paying factor and Monday did nothing to it.
- **Asian FX is trading better than Asian equity.** USD/KRW 1,382.45 with the won up 2.3% last week; USD/TWD 31.7852; USD/JPY 159.076 in an 8.8-pip range. Korea's currency strengthened through a week its index lost 3.1% in a session — foreign selling of Korean semis is not yet showing up as capital flight.
- **Energy sold the sanctions.** WTI \$85.01 (−2.36%), Brent \$92.17 (−2.35%), spread \$7.16, RBOB −2.56%. Crude still holds bullish TREND at 56% of its 80.93–88.21 band and is up 6.9% on the week, so this was a give-back inside an uptrend rather than a break.
- **Natural gas is the awkward one.** \$2.782, +0.33%, sitting at 68% of a 2.64–2.85 band that Hedgeye signals bearish. A bearish-TREND instrument trading in the top third of its range is a signal under pressure, and it is the third such case in the set alongside VIX and LQD.
- **The metals disagreed with each other.** Gold futures +0.37% and GLD +0.79%; silver futures −1.35% and SLV −0.83%; copper futures +0.27%. Gold is breaking out, silver is not confirming, and copper — despite an 11% week in the miners — sits lowest in its band at 36.8%. Precious-metal leadership is narrow.

4 Hedgeye — regime, risk ranges & the Quad path

Macro dashboard

ITEM	READING	NOTE
Quad path	July Quad 4 → August Quad 3 → potential September Quad 1	No explicit path notation such as "3 → 1 → 2" was printed in Monday's Early Look or KM's Top 3. This sequence is taken from The Macro Show summary notes, which are AI-generated and carry their own error caveat. The potential September Quad 1 is new language and is flagged accordingly.
Core long factor	Short US dollar	DXY bearish TREND. Expressed long EUR/USD, long USD/JPY, long gold, long Colombia (COLO), long bitcoin exposure.
Equity sector pair	Long healthcare (XLV, FXH) / short utilities (XLU)	+1,100bp of relative performance in just over three weeks. XLU is the book's only sector short.
Technology stance	Long software (IGV), no position in semis or Korea	Buying software dips; no EWY and no DRAM into Nvidia's print.
Reflation basket	Oil, copper miners (ICOP), lumber (WOOD), sugar, corn	Oil +6.9%, copper miners +11%, sugar +6.1%, corn +5.2%, lumber +1.06%, all week-on-week.
Volatility	"Investable bucket" across VIX, Nasdaq vol, Russell vol	Not a hedging regime in the house's framing.
Rates	10-year bullish TREND; 2-year newly flipped bullish TREND	10-year +4bp last week, 2-year +6bp. September FOMC is 16 September; a rate <i>increase</i> is priced near 31%, having reached 58% before last month's softer inflation print.
Book changes seen	ETF Pro: removed long Drone & Modern Warfare (JEDI)	Signal Strength Stocks: 80 names, 0 added, 6 removed — FSLY, NVDA , URI, TTWO, ATRO, COMP. Nvidia dropping out of the signal list two days before it reports is the notable line.

Risk Range™ Signals — Monday 24 August Early Look, published 19:01 GMT+8

INSTRUMENT	IMMEDIATE-TERM RANGE	TREND	LIVE	WHERE IT STANDS
UST 10Y Yield	4.65 - 4.75	Bullish	4.700	50.0% — exactly mid-band
High Yield (HYG)	79.42 - 79.90	Bullish	79.70	58.3% — credit unbothered
Inv. Grade (LQD)	105.4 - 106.6	Bearish	106.18	65.0% — upper half of a bearish band
S&P 500	7,617 - 7,824	Bullish	7,652.86	17.3% — 0.47% above the floor
Nasdaq Composite	25,903 - 26,821	Bullish	25,980.19	8.4% — 0.30% above the floor, the tightest in the set
Russell 2000	2,975 - 3,075	Bullish	2,995.08	20.1% — 0.67% above the floor
Health Care (XLV)	168 - 177	Bullish	174.70	74.4% — the long is working
Equal Weight (RSP)	219.00 - 225.00	Bullish	221.93	48.8% — mid-band, the broad market is fine
Software (IGV)	99.00 - 106.00	Bullish	n/a	Not captured this run — see KNOWN GAPS

INSTRUMENT	IMMEDIATE-TERM RANGE	TREND	LIVE	WHERE IT STANDS
Volatility (VIX)	13.79 - 16.28	Bearish	15.84	82.3% — pressing the ceiling of a bearish band
US Dollar (DXY)	98.40 - 99.86	Bearish	98.983	39.9% — short-dollar comfortable
WTI Crude (cont.)	80.93 - 88.21	Bullish	85.01	56.0% — mid-band after a -2.4% day
Nat Gas (cont.)	2.64 - 2.85	Bearish	2.782	67.6% — upper third of a bearish band
Gold (spot)	4,403 - 4,694	Bullish	4,657.67	87.5% — 0.78% from the ceiling
Copper (spot)	6.47 - 6.74	Bullish	6.5693	36.8% — the laggard of the metals
Silver (spot)	64 - 71	Bullish	69.048	72.1% — high, but not confirming gold

Band positions are measured on the exact series Hedgeye names: spot for gold, silver and copper (TVC:GOLD, TVC:SILVER, OANDA:XCUUSD), continuous front-month futures for crude and natural gas (NYMEX:CL1!, NYMEX:NG1!). This matters materially — measured on futures instead, gold would read 101.3% and sit outside its band rather than at 87.5% inside it, copper would read 50.0% rather than 36.8%, and silver 65.6% rather than 72.1%. **Band-to-band comparison against the previous session could not be performed this run** — Hedgeye's Early Look category page does not paginate to Friday's note and the prior edition's archived copy is not machine-readable from this session. The floor, ceiling and width moves are therefore unknown, not unchanged. See KNOWN GAPS.

Read-through

The signal set as a whole is under more pressure than any single line admits. Every bullish-TREND equity instrument is sitting in the bottom fifth of its band — Nasdaq at 8.4%, S&P at 17.3%, Russell at 20.1% — while every bearish-TREND instrument is sitting in the upper half of its own: VIX at 82.3%, LQD at 65.0%, natural gas at 67.6%. The bullish names are near their floors and the bearish names near their ceilings. That configuration does not invalidate the signals, but it is the arrangement that precedes a signal change, and the Nasdaq needs only 0.30% to test it.

What Keith actually said

From **KM's Top 3 Things (KOSPI/Gold/Sectors)**, Keith McCullough, published 18:30 GMT+8 Monday 24 August:

- On Korea: *"the Dr. woke up ill this morning with KOSPI, once again, breaking down through our critical immediate-term TRADE Signal Level of 6796, down -3.1% on the day, taking its crash back to -26.6% from its #MOAB Cycle Peak"* — adding that he has *"no position in either EWY or Semis (DRAM) heading into NVDA Wednesday (choosing no position is a position!)"* and continues to *"buy the dips in Software (IGV) instead"*.
- On gold: *"the biggest 'new' breakout in Big Macro continues to be Gold which is up another +0.8% this morning after breaking out to Bullish TRADE and TREND during this July-Aug Quad Shift - it's Risk Range™ Signal = \$4403-4694 and implies big-higher-lows and new daily highs in the Range which is just bullish"*.
- On sectors: *"another big day for us in Long/Short US Equity Sector Style selection on Friday with our only Sector Short (Utilities, XLU) down another -2.3% on the day to -3.6% for AUG during this textbook Quad Shift out of #Quad4 in JUL (where we were long XLU!); Long Healthcare (XLV) has been a beast, up another +1.3% on Friday to +7.4% in AUG which is +1,100bps of performance over XLU in just over 3 weeks!"*

Monday's Early Look, **"Dollar Down, Reflation Up"** (19:01 GMT+8), was written by **Ryan Ricci**, not by McCullough. Its framing line was: *"The beauty of this profession is that every single day something can change... But the ultimate question is do you have a process to see the changes?"* On positioning it stated: *"We are short the US Dollar vs Long Euro/US Dollar and Long US Dollar / Yen"*, and on the September meeting that *"The current odds of a rate increase for the September meeting are 31% and got as high as 58% before the last inflation decelerating print last month."*

Attributed summary, not quotation. The Macro Show notes for Monday 24 August are explicitly AI-enhanced and carry a stated error caveat, so the following is reported outside quotation marks. Sam described flipping his portfolio over roughly six to eight weeks from six or seven semiconductor and hardware names with one or two software names, to two semiconductor names — Nvidia and Marvell — and roughly six to eight software names, citing concerns about AI financing structures and describing the reduction in risk profile as the appropriate response. He expects Nvidia to report a very strong quarter with data-centre revenue approaching double its year-ago level, while keeping the position deliberately restrained because the beat must clear already-high expectations. He flagged roughly 15% price increases on Nvidia chips and servers next year on memory inflation. Daryl attributed recent high-beta underperformance to month- and quarter-end positioning, compounded by the continuing unwind of a large hedge-fund book reportedly taken over by Citadel.

5 Mag7 scoreboard

NAME	LAST	DAY	CAP	READ
Nvidia (NVDA)	208.48	-2.91%	\$5.05tn	Seventh straight decline, first since Sept 2022. 134.7m shares against a 100.4m ten-day average. 11.9% off its 52-week high, reporting Wednesday. Removed from Hedgeye's Signal Strength list on Monday.
Apple (AAPL)	310.34	+0.32%	\$4.53tn	The quiet mega-cap. Only 9.9% off its high — the smallest drawdown in the group and the reason the index held.
Alphabet (GOOGL)	348.06	+0.94%	\$4.24tn	Traded a 9-point range and closed near the top of it. 14.8% off its high; now the third-largest company and closing on Apple.
Microsoft (MSFT)	487.31	+0.84%	\$3.62tn	Recovered a \$481.86 low to close at \$487.31. Named a large active long on The Macro Show. 12.0% off its high.
	262.07	+1.33%	\$2.83tn	

NAME	LAST	DAY	CAP	READ
Amazon (AMZN)				Best of the trillion-dollar names. Only 8.8% below its 52-week high — the shallowest drawdown of the seven.
Meta (META)	559.02	+1.66%	\$1.42tn	Strongest day in the group, off a \$546.30 low — yet still 29.3% below its 52-week high of \$790.80. The rally is off a deep base, not a high one.
Tesla (TSLA)	348.95	-3.83%	\$1.38tn	Worst of the seven. Hit by the 50% Canadian tariff on autos and components effective 1 January 2027, plus a 2.98m-vehicle China recall over door handles. 30.0% off its high and now the smallest Mag7 name.

Capitalisations are TradingView's market_cap_basic at capture and move with the live price; they are indicative to roughly the nearest \$10bn, not exact. Nvidia's after-hours print was \$208.89 (+0.20%) at 18:07 ET; no Mag7 name moved more than 0.20% after the bell.

6 Positioning & options

- **The volatility bid was disproportionate to the move.** VIX +4.62% to 15.84 against an S&P down 0.28%. That ratio implies hedging demand rather than liquidation, and it lands with VIX at 82% of a band whose TREND signal is bearish — the most stretched relationship in the risk-range set.
- **Volume concentrated where the damage was.** Nvidia traded 134.7m shares against a 100.4m ten-day average (+34%). Micron traded 29.8m against 30.5m — in line. Intel traded 96.5m against 113.3m — *below* average on a 3.1% decline. The forced activity was in Nvidia, not across the complex.
- **Month-end mechanics are doing part of this.** The Macro Show attributed recent high-beta underperformance versus low-beta, and high-sales-growth underperformance versus low-growth, to month- and quarter-end positioning — hedge funds covering shorts, selling winning longs and closing books. Late-August volume is thin enough for that to leave marks.
- **A single-book unwind remains in the tape.** The continuing liquidation of a large hedge-fund portfolio reportedly assumed by Citadel was described as largely complete but with residual exposure capable of producing volatility. Attributed to the AI-generated Macro Show summary and not independently verified here.
- **Hedgeye's high-beta momentum basket fell 10.5% week-on-week** — but that basket is short software while the house is long it, so the number overstates the pain in outright momentum longs and understates the dispersion.
- **Equal-weight beat cap-weight by 41bp** (RSP +0.117% vs SPY -0.294%), and HYG rose 0.113% with LQD up 0.245%. Credit did not participate in the equity wobble at all, which is the strongest single argument that Monday was idiosyncratic.

7 Sector rotation — leaders & laggards

SECTOR (SPDR)	LAST	DAY	NOTE
Consumer Staples (XLP)	87.45	+1.70%	Best sector. Closed at the very top of its range.
Financials (XLF)	58.22	+1.29%	Rose into a bull-flattening curve — unusual, and a vote for credit quality over margin.
Utilities (XLU)	43.22	+1.05%	Hedgeye's only sector short, and it was third best. Down 3.6% for August, so the trade is still well ahead.
Communication Services (XLC)	112.32	+0.83%	Carried by Alphabet and Meta.
Real Estate (XLRE)	45.33	+0.56%	Long-end rally fed straight through.
Consumer Discretionary (XLY)	118.30	+0.24%	Positive <i>despite</i> Tesla -3.83%. The rest of the sector was materially stronger than the headline.
Materials (XLB)	53.58	+0.08%	Gave back most of a strong Friday driven by copper and gold names.
Health Care (XLV)	174.70	+0.05%	Essentially flat after a 7.4% August. UNH +2.22% and JNJ +1.04% offset Lilly -0.68%.
Industrials (XLI)	179.00	-0.69%	Tariff-exposed manufacturing took the Canada headline badly.
Energy (XLE)	63.11	-0.83%	Fell far less than the 2.4% drop in crude — the equities did not believe the barrel move.
Technology (XLK)	180.05	-1.78%	The only material decline, and it accounts for essentially the entire index loss.

- **Leaders:** staples, financials and utilities — the three most defensive corners of the market, taking the top three places on a day the index barely moved. That is not rotation into strength; it is rotation into shelter.
- **Laggards:** technology alone did the damage, at -1.78%, with semiconductors inside it at -2.70%. Energy's -0.83% against crude's -2.36% is the more interesting divergence: the equity market marked the oil move as noise.
- **Rotation read:** eight sectors up, three down, and the index lower. Dispersion is running high enough that The Macro Show called it out explicitly. For a long/short book this is a good tape; for anyone holding the index it looks like a bad one. Both are true and they are the same day.

8 Forward — futures & the week ahead

Globex reopened at 18:00 ET, seven minutes before this capture, so the overnight tape has barely started. ES sits at 7,669.75, NQ at 29,105.75, YM at 53,489 and RTY at 3,001.60 — all carrying Monday's day-session change into a session that has produced no information yet. The ES-to-cash basis of 16.89 points is normal carry, which confirms Monday's cash settle is a genuine settle. The after-hours window from 16:05 to 18:00 ET has now closed and produced nothing: no Mag7 name moved more than 0.20%, and the largest post-close move in the whole capture was SanDisk at -0.34%. Asia therefore opens on Monday's information, not on anything new.

DAY (GMT+8)	KEY EVENTS
Tue 25 Aug	Asian cash opens: Tokyo/Seoul 08:00-08:30, Hong Kong 09:30, India 12:15. US Conference Board consumer confidence (22:00). New home sales. Light earnings.
Wed 26 Aug	Nvidia Q2 FY2027 after the US close — consensus revenue near \$91.8bn, roughly +67% year on year, with buy-side whispers in the \$93-95bn range. US July durable goods orders 20:30 GMT+8, consensus +0.7%. This is the week's binary event.
Thu 27 Aug	Jackson Hole symposium opens (27-29 August). US initial jobless claims. Pending home sales.
Fri 28 Aug	Fed Chair Kevin Warsh's first Jackson Hole keynote, 10:00 ET (22:00 GMT+8). July PCE — the Fed's preferred inflation gauge — plus personal income and outlays, 20:30 GMT+8. Final UMich sentiment.
Ahead	US August CPI on 11 September, which Hedgeye expects to accelerate. FOMC 16 September, with roughly 31% priced on a rate <i>increase</i> . Canadian retaliatory tariffs take effect 8 September.

Nvidia's report date and the Jackson Hole dates were both verified against primary and named-outlet reporting rather than carried forward; Warsh's keynote is reported by Bloomberg and Yahoo Finance as his first as Chair, having taken office on 22 May 2026. One secondary source placed the keynote on 29 August rather than 28 August; the 28 August, 10:00 ET timing is the better-corroborated of the two and is marked accordingly in section 18.

9 Corporate news

- **Samsung's capital-return plan is the origin of the whole day.** A record shareholder-return announcement fell short of expectations, the shares fell roughly 9% in Seoul, and the disappointment propagated straight through the global memory complex. This was a payout story, not a demand story, and it exposed how crowded the memory trade had become.
- **Memory names took the hit in New York.** Micron -5.83% to \$910.43, SanDisk -6.45% to \$1,493.12, Western Digital -5.24% to \$435.38. Micron's close is 27.5% below its 52-week high; SanDisk's 36.6% below; Western Digital's 45.6% below. Hedgeye's Early Look nonetheless notes SanDisk, Micron and Marvell all remain bullish TREND on its own signals.
- **Tesla carried two separate problems.** A 50% US tariff on all Canadian imports including vehicles, components and steel, effective 1 January 2027, and a 2.98m-vehicle recall in China over emergency door handles — a recall covering roughly eleven times the company's 2026 unit sales to date. The stock fell 3.83% alongside Ford, GM and Stellantis.
- **Oracle's position deserves separate mention.** Down 2.75% to \$142.45 on the day, but **58.8% below its 52-week high of \$345.72**. No single company better illustrates the gap between an index near records and an AI-infrastructure complex that has already been through a bear market.
- **Health care was the offset.** UnitedHealth +2.22% to \$398.76 and Johnson & Johnson +1.04% to \$273.04 against Eli Lilly -0.68% at \$1,246.93 — Lilly now within 3.5% of its own 52-week high, the closest of any large-cap in this capture.
- **Hedgeye book changes.** ETF Pro removed its long in Drone and Modern Warfare (JEDI) at a 27.41-31.85 range. Signal Strength Stocks moved to 80 names with six removals — FSLY, NVDA, URI, TTWO, ATRO and COMP — and no additions.

10 Macro data

- **Monday was an empty calendar and that is worth stating plainly.** No tier-one US release printed. The Chicago Fed National Activity Index was the only scheduled item of note. Nothing in Monday's price action can be attributed to data, which strengthens the case that the move was positioning and a single overseas corporate headline.
- **July durable goods orders land Wednesday, 26 August, 08:30 ET, consensus +0.7%.** Street estimates cluster at +0.6% headline, +0.7% ex-defence and +0.8% ex-transport. It is the first hard read on capital spending since the tariff escalation.
- **July PCE prints Friday, 28 August, 08:30 ET** — the Fed's preferred gauge, arriving the same morning as the Chair's keynote. Consensus figures were not confirmed from a primary source in this run and are deliberately not printed.
- **August CPI on 11 September is the number that matters for September.** Hedgeye expects headline inflation to accelerate. With roughly 31% priced on a September *hike* — down from 58% before last month's softer print — an accelerating CPI would reprice that fast.
- **Consumer confidence today, 25 August.** Consensus not confirmed from a primary source and therefore not printed. Sources disagreed on whether the release falls on the 25th or 26th; the 25th is the better-supported date and is flagged in section 18.

- **The rate market is pricing a hike, not a cut, and that has not changed.** Both the 2-year at 4.238% flipping to bullish TREND and the 31% hike probability point the same way, into a Jackson Hole where the new Chair has said he wants to "frame the big questions".

11 Geopolitics

- **◆ Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent announced "Operation Economic Outcast" on Monday** — the widest Iran sanctions package of this administration. It expands secondary-sanction categories for entities and countries transacting with Tehran and adds new sanctions across digital assets, gold, aviation, technology and shipping, with Treasury saying it has mapped the networks, facilitators and financial channels involved. Bessent framed the choice for Iran as complete isolation and a subsistence economy, or a path back to the global economy.
- **▼ Oil fell 2.36% on the announcement.** The market read expanded sanctions as the substitute for military action rather than the prelude to it — the "no war, no deal" outcome. Reporting suggests secondary sanctions are the expected main line of action at least until after the midterms.
- **◆ The Strait of Hormuz remains the unresolved variable.** Hedgeye's read of Polymarket has the odds of traffic normalising by December falling from 62% toward a 34% low, while the odds of a US invasion before 2027 sit near 17%. Tanker shipping (BWET) was the best-performing ETF of last week outside bitcoin. These are market-implied probabilities from a prediction market, not forecasts, and are thin marks.
- **▼ US-Canada trade negotiations have collapsed.** A 50% US tariff on hundreds of Canadian goods — furniture, plastics, plywood, electrical equipment, and separately autos, components and steel from 1 January 2027 — took effect Saturday, covering roughly \$20-28bn of trade depending on the source. Prime Minister Mark Carney has matched dollar for dollar, with Canadian retaliation effective 8 September.
- **▼ The tariff transmitted directly into US equities.** Industrials -0.69% and the whole North American auto complex lower. Estimates put the affected share at roughly 5% of Canadian exports to the US, layered on existing steel, lumber and auto tariffs.
- **◆ Korea is now a geopolitical as much as a corporate story.** A 3.1% index decline and a 26.6% drawdown from cycle peak in the world's most semiconductor-concentrated equity market, against a currency that strengthened 2.3% last week, is a dislocation worth watching in its own right.

12 Overnight setup — what Asia opens into

INSTRUMENT	LIVE	CHANGE	VOLUME / NOTE
ES (E-mini S&P)	7,669.75	-0.28%	1,044,788 lots · change is Monday's session
NQ (E-mini Nasdaq)	29,105.75	-0.96%	518,759 lots · the hand-off instrument
YM (E-mini Dow)	53,489	+0.26%	57,329 lots
RTY (E-mini Russell)	3,001.60	-0.68%	114,971 lots · above 3,000 where cash closed below
USD/JPY	159.076	-0.00%	8.8-pip range · inert
USD/KRW	1,382.45	-0.21%	Won firm into a broken KOSPI
USD/TWD	31.7852	+0.05%	The other semiconductor currency
USD/CNH	6.72089	-0.01%	Stable
EUR/USD	1.16648	+0.01%	+1.5% on the month
Gold (spot)	\$4,657.67	+0.13%	0.78% below its risk-range ceiling
Silver (spot)	\$69.048	+0.13%	Not confirming gold
Copper (spot)	\$6.5693	-0.00%	36.8% of band — weakest metal
WTI crude	\$85.01	-2.36%	Change is Monday's session
Brent crude	\$92.17	-2.35%	Spread \$7.16
Bitcoin	\$78,949.53	+1.60%	22h of session · failed \$24 short of \$80,000
Ether	\$2,483.66	+0.86%	ETH/BTC 0.0315 — deeply subordinate

Previous Asian closes, all Monday 24 August and 14-16 hours old at capture: Nikkei 225 **65,527.87** (-0.74%), Hang Seng **25,517.34** (-1.89%), KOSPI **6,696.97** (-3.12%), Shanghai Composite **3,882.01** (-0.59%), ASX 200 **9,103.10** (+0.49%), SENSEX **77,369.11** (-0.22%). European closes, Monday, roughly 6.6 hours old: Euro Stoxx 50 **6,447.99** (-0.22%), DAX **26,106.60** (-0.12%), FTSE 100 **10,854.33** (+0.35%), CAC 40 **8,453.02** (-0.37%), IBEX 35 **20,098.59** (+0.69%).

- **The US hands Asia a semiconductor problem and nothing else.** Technology was the only materially negative sector at -1.78%; eight sectors closed higher and the NYSE Composite was unchanged. An Asian open that sells the broad index rather than the chip complex will have over-read the American tape.
- **Korea is the instrument most likely to move.** The KOSPI closed at 6,696.97, below the 6,796 TRADE line, 26.6% off its cycle peak, and the American memory names then fell another 5-6% after Seoul closed. That gap has not been priced. A won that strengthened 2.3% last week is the offsetting argument, and the two cannot both be right for long.
- **Taiwan reprises the same input with a different mix.** USD/TWD at 31.7852 and a foundry-weighted rather than memory-weighted index means Taipei should take less damage than Seoul — the SOX's 64%-of-range close and the 2.43% decline in SMH argue for a fade rather than an extension.

- **Japan has the cleanest set-up.** USD/JPY inert at 159.076, the Nikkei already down 0.74% on Monday, and a Dow that rose 0.26%. Japanese value and financials should track the American rotation rather than the American technology loss.
- **Gold into the Asian session is the one to watch for a signal change,** not a price move. At 87.5% of its band and 0.78% from the ceiling, Asian buying would push it out of range and force the band itself to move.
- **Everything is provisional until Wednesday.** Nvidia reports after the US close on 26 August into a stock that has fallen seven straight sessions. Positioning into that event will dominate two more Asian sessions regardless of what any of these levels do overnight.

13 AI watch

- **The financing structure, not the technology, is what changed sentiment.** The Macro Show's argument was that one can be positive on AI's transformative potential and simultaneously concerned about circular financing, rising debt and on- and off-balance-sheet obligations — with arrangements in which chip suppliers invest in customers who then buy their chips singled out as the concerning case. That reasoning drove a portfolio shift from six or seven hardware names to two.
- **Memory inflation is now an explicit input to AI unit economics.** Nvidia is reported to be signalling roughly 15% price increases on chips and servers next year, attributed to memory cost inflation. That reframes Monday's memory selloff: cheaper memory equities and dearer memory chips are not the same trade.
- **The demand case into Wednesday remains large.** Data-centre revenue approaching double its year-ago level, the Vera Rubin transition, increased hyperscaler purchasing, and SpaceX described as a new incremental source of AI-infrastructure demand. The question is the size of the beat against expectations, not the direction.
- **Meta's capital programme is the bear case being articulated most clearly.** A core advertising business at 40–45% operating margins funding an attempt to build proprietary models and compute, with open questions on duration, cost, margin impact and whether it ends as a fourth- or fifth-tier compute player. Meta is 29.3% below its 52-week high while rising 1.66% on Monday.
- **Adoption is still described as early.** Coding is producing tangible productivity gains; consumer applications have not yet produced their behavioural impact. Personalised agents managing calendars, reservations and travel were named as the plausible next step, with a consumer company such as Apple positioned to create the moment that shifts AI from question-answering to habit.
- **The tape has already voted on infrastructure.** Oracle –58.8%, Western Digital –45.6%, Intel –38.7%, SanDisk –36.6%, Applied Materials –34.5%, all from 52-week highs, while the S&P sits near its own. Whatever the AI trade is now, it is not the trade it was nine months ago.

14 Beyond the markets

- **Utilities rose 1.05% on Monday and almost nobody will mention it,** because it is the position Hedgeye is short and the trade is still up 3.6% for the month. The most useful thing a signal can do is have a bad day inside a good month; that is what distinguishes a trade under pressure from a trade that is wrong.
- **Bitcoin printed \$79,976.16.** Twenty-four dollars. The round number held on the first attempt after a 24% week, and it held during Asian hours rather than American ones.
- **SanDisk's 52-week low is \$46.75 and it closed at \$1,493.12.** Even after a 36.6% drawdown from its high and a 6.45% fall on Monday, that is a range no risk model calibrated a year ago would have contained. Position sizing in that name is a different exercise from analysis of it.
- **Financials rose 1.29% into a bull-flattening curve.** A flatter curve is conventionally bad for bank margin, so the sector rose against its own textbook — which usually means the market is paying for balance-sheet quality and credit stability rather than net interest income. HYG's rise on the same day supports that.
- **Energy equities fell a third as much as the barrel.** XLE –0.83% against WTI –2.36%. Equity holders marked the sanctions-day decline as noise. One of those two markets is wrong about the durability of the Hormuz premium, and the answer arrives slowly.
- **The new Fed Chair has stopped telegraphing.** Under Warsh the Fed no longer signals intentions ahead of meetings, which means Friday's keynote carries genuine information rather than confirmation — a structurally different Jackson Hole from the last several, arriving on the same morning as PCE.

15 Appendix — stock cards**NVDA · NVIDIA****\$208.48** **-2.91%**Cap \$5.05tn · 52wk 164.07-236.54 · -11.9% off high · Q2 FY27
Wed 26 Aug after the close

Seventh straight decline, the first since September 2022, on volume 34% above its ten-day average. Removed from Hedgeye's Signal Strength list on Monday. The largest company in the world entering a binary print with a broken short-term tape.

MU · MICRON**\$910.43** **-5.83%**

Cap \$1.03tn · 52wk 114.25-1,255.00 · -27.5% off high

The clearest transmission of Samsung's capital-return disappointment. Still bullish TREND on Hedgeye's signals despite the move. A 52-week range of eleven-fold makes any percentage judgement about this name unstable.

SNDK · SANDISK**\$1,493.12** **-6.45%**

Cap \$219bn · 52wk 46.75-2,354.39 · -36.6% off high

Worst large-cap decline in the capture, and the only name to move more than 0.30% after the bell (-0.34%). Named in Hedgeye's risk-range product and still bullish TREND. Traded from \$47 to \$2,354 within twelve months.

WDC · WESTERN DIGITAL**\$435.38** **-5.24%**

Cap \$157bn · 52wk 77.90-799.87 · -45.6% off high

Traded a \$27 range and closed near the middle of it. Nearly halved from its high while the index sits near records — the single starkest illustration of how far the storage complex has already been repriced.

TSLA · TESLA**\$348.95** **-3.83%**

Cap \$1.38tn · 52wk 297.38-498.83 · -30.0% off high

Two distinct problems on one day: a 50% Canadian tariff on autos and components from 1 January 2027, and a 2.98m-vehicle China recall over door handles. Now the smallest Mag7 name, below Meta.

ORCL · ORACLE**\$142.45** **-2.75%**

Cap \$410bn · 52wk 114.50-345.72 · -58.8% off high

The most extreme drawdown in this capture. Closed nearer its 52-week low than its high. If the AI-financing concern has a single share price attached to it, this is that price.

META · META PLATFORMS**\$559.02** **+1.66%**

Cap \$1.42tn · 52wk 520.26-790.80 · -29.3% off high

Best Mag7 performer on the day off a \$546.30 low, yet still 29% below its high and named as a negative view — not a short — on The Macro Show over capex duration, margin impact and competitive position in compute.

UNH · UNITEDHEALTH**\$398.76** **+2.22%**

Cap \$358bn · 52wk 255.97-461.62 · -13.6% off high

Largest gainer among the names tracked here and the reason XLV held flat on a day Lilly fell. Healthcare has produced 1,100bp of relative performance over utilities in three weeks; this is where it came from.

AMZN · AMAZON**\$262.07** **+1.33%**

Cap \$2.83tn · 52wk 196.00-287.20 · -8.8% off high

The shallowest drawdown of the Mag7 and a large named active long on The Macro Show. Closed near the top of its range. Quietly the strongest chart in the mega-cap complex.

LLY · ELI LILLY**\$1,246.93** **-0.68%**

Cap \$1.17tn · 52wk 712.05-1,292.65 · -3.5% off high

Closer to its 52-week high than any other large-cap in this capture. A modest down day inside a name that has done nothing but work. The healthcare long is not a defensive trade here; it is a momentum one.

16 About this edition

- **Covers** — Monday 24 August's US cash session as settled, the 16:05-18:00 ET after-hours window in full, the first seven minutes of the new Globex session, the complete Hedgeye evening publication set, and overnight FX, metals and crypto to the moment of capture.
- **Captured** — 06:07:18 to 06:07:20 GMT+8, a 2.1-second window, via one bulk TradingView scanner call returning 96 instruments. Yahoo Finance was queried concurrently and aborted on its circuit breaker after five consecutive HTTP 429s; the run is TradingView-single-sourced. Divergences and the manual cross-checks that replaced the automatic reconciliation are documented in section 18.
- **Settled vs live** — US cash equities, the VIX and all Asian and European index levels are settled closes. US index futures and energy futures carry live levels but Monday's day-session change and range, because Globex reopened only seven minutes before capture. Spot metals and FX carry live levels but change figures measured over just 67 minutes since the 17:00 ET roll; those changes are noise and are marked amber throughout. Bitcoin and Ether are the only genuinely full-session rows, at 22 hours.
- **Hedgeye edition** — full logged-in access reached. Monday 24 August's Early Look, "**Dollar Down, Reflation Up**" by **Ryan Ricci** (19:01 GMT+8), is the live risk-range set; Tuesday evening's Early Look supersedes it at roughly 19:00 GMT+8 tonight. Also read in full: KM's Top 3 Things (Keith McCullough, 18:30 GMT+8), The Macro Show summary notes for Monday (22:11 GMT+8), the ETF Pro Plus update (01:08 GMT+8 Tuesday) and Signal Strength Stocks (02:56 GMT+8 Tuesday).
- **Quad path — flagged: the September call is new.** July Quad 4 → August Quad 3 → **potential September Quad 1**. No explicit path notation was printed in the Early Look or KM's Top 3; this sequence comes from the AI-generated Macro Show summary and from McCullough's references to a "textbook Quad Shift out of #Quad4 in JUL". The absence of a printed path is not evidence the path is unchanged.
- **Not available** — the previous session's Hedgeye Early Look, so no band-to-band diff was possible; a live IGV price for the software risk range; MOMO Tracker, Crypto Quant and Chart of the Day, none of which appeared in the feed since the previous edition; and any independent machine price source, Yahoo having been rate-limited.

17 Sources

Prices. TradingView global scanner, one bulk call, 06:07:18-06:07:20 GMT+8, 96 of 96 instruments returned — cash indices, futures, cash Treasury yields, spot and futures metals, FX, crypto, sector SPDRs and single stocks, with market capitalisation, 52-week ranges, ten-day average volume and post-market prints from the same call. Yahoo Finance was queried concurrently as the intended cross-check and returned nothing, aborting on five consecutive HTTP 429s.

Hedgeye. Logged-in feed at app.hedgeye.com, read 06:10-06:22 GMT+8: the Early Look category view and the individual items for KM's Top 3 Things, The Macro Show summary notes, ETF Pro Plus and Signal Strength Stocks. All feed timestamps are ET and were converted at +12 hours for US daylight time.

Macro and policy. Newsquawk's weekly economic calendar, Kiplinger and FinancialJuice for the 24-28 August schedule; Continuum Economics and Investing.com for the durable goods consensus; Bloomberg, Yahoo Finance and CNBC for the Jackson Hole dates and Kevin Warsh's keynote; the US Census Bureau advance durable goods release page for the scheduled date and time.

Session narrative and single stocks. CNBC's market live blog, TheStreet, Yahoo Finance markets live, The Washington Post's Associated Press index wire, Seeking Alpha, TipRanks, Investing.com, TradingKey and Fortune for the memory selloff, the Samsung capital-return disappointment, Nvidia's seven-session streak and Tesla's tariff and recall headlines.

Commodities, geopolitics and AI. The Washington Post, CBS News, Axios, NPR and Just The News on Operation Economic Outcast; The Washington Post, Al Jazeera, Blakes and the Office of the Prime Minister of Canada on the US-Canada tariff escalation; Yahoo Finance, CryptoTimes and TechTimes on the bitcoin move; The Macro Show summary notes for the AI financing and adoption material.

18 Data-confidence

CROSS-CHECKS PASSED

- **The automatic reconciliation produced nothing and must not be read as a clean result.** The script reports 0 matched within 5bp, 0 minor, 0 divergent and **57 single-sourced pairs**. There are no divergent rows to resolve *because no second machine source ran*. Every price in this document rests on one vendor unless named below.
- **Manual cross-check on the three headline indices passed exactly.** Press wire reporting of Monday's close gives S&P 500 -0.28% at 7,652.86, Nasdaq Composite -0.76% at 25,980.19 and Dow Jones +0.26% at 53,417.16. The capture returns 7,652.86 (-0.2803%), 25,980.19 (-0.765%) and 53,417.16 (+0.263%). Agreement to the cent and to within 0.005pp on the percentages, from a genuinely independent source.
- **Cash index arithmetic is self-consistent.** S&P: $7,652.86 + 21.51 = 7,674.37$ prior close; $21.51 \div 7,674.37 = 0.2803\%$ — matches the reported change. Nasdaq: $25,980.19 + 200.26 = 26,180.45$; $200.26 \div 26,180.45 = 0.765\%$ — matches. Dow: $53,417.16 - 140.15 = 53,277.01$; $140.15 \div 53,277.01 = 0.263\%$ — matches. Every close also sits inside its own reported high-low range.
- **Futures-to-cash basis confirms the settles are genuine settles.** ES 7,669.75 against SPX 7,652.86 is +16.89 points, or +0.22% — normal positive carry for a quarterly contract, not a dislocation. YM 53,489 against Dow 53,417.16 is +71.8, or +0.13%. RTY 3,001.60 against RUT 2,995.08 is +6.52, or +0.22%. Three contracts, three consistent bases; a mislabelled settle would have shown up as an outlier here and did not.
- **Micron cross-checked against independent reporting.** Seeking Alpha reports a Monday close of \$911.27 against the capture's \$910.43 — a 0.09% gap, within normal consolidated-tape variance. A separate report of MU "down 7.1% to \$897.77" does not match either and is treated as an intraday or pre-open print, not a close.
- **Semiconductor index cross-check partially passed.** Press reporting of the iShares Semiconductor ETF at -2.7% matches the capture's SOXX at -2.667% closely. See the conflict on the SOX index itself below.

- **Hedgeye risk-range positions recomputed on the named series.** Gold: $(4,657.673 - 4,403) \div (4,694 - 4,403) = 87.5\%$. Copper: $(6.56928 - 6.47) \div 0.27 = 36.8\%$. Silver: $(69.0476 - 64) \div 7 = 72.1\%$. Nasdaq: $(25,980.19 - 25,903) \div 918 = 8.4\%$. Measuring the metals on futures instead would have given 101.3%, 50.0% and 65.6% respectively — the gold error alone would have placed it outside its band.

KNOWN CONFLICTS AND WEAK MARKS

- **SOX index level conflicts with one press account.** The capture gives the Philadelphia Semiconductor Index at 11,423.16, -2.702%. One search summary reported the index down 3.5% on the day. The brief uses the capture, because the same source's SOXX figure of -2.7% agrees with the capture's -2.667% and the two cannot both be right; the -3.5% figure most likely refers to an intraday low or a different index. The direction and character of the move are robust; the second decimal is not.
- **All spot metal and FX change figures are measured over 67 minutes and are close to meaningless.** Gold spot shows +0.126%, silver +0.128% and copper -0.003% because the 17:00 ET roll started a new session. Monday's actual gold move was +0.37% on futures and +0.79% on GLD; silver actually *fell* 1.35% on futures. The **levels** are live and reliable, and the risk-range positions computed from them are sound. The **changes** are not, and are marked amber in every table.
- **USD/KRW and DXY change figures are ambiguous rather than simply short.** USD/JPY and EUR/USD show 8.8-pip and 6.6-pip ranges consistent with a 67-minute session, but USD/KRW shows a 9.75-won range and DXY a 0.30-point range — both too wide for that window, suggesting those series carry more of Monday's session. Their change figures should be treated as low-confidence in either direction.
- **US index futures change and range are Monday's day session, not the overnight tape.** Globex reopened at 18:00 ET and capture was at 18:07 ET, but the vendor's daily bars for ES, NQ, YM, RTY, CL and NG had not yet rolled — evidenced by full-day ranges such as ES 7,655-7,703.25. The levels are live to seven minutes; the changes describe Monday. This is stated in the table sub-headers and repeated here because it is the easiest thing in the document to misread.
- **Market capitalisations are indicative.** TradingView's market_cap_basic moves with the live price and uses a basic rather than fully diluted share count. Treat the Mag7 figures as accurate to roughly the nearest \$10bn — sufficient to rank the seven, insufficient for any calculation that depends on the precise number.
- **Drawdown percentages rest on a single 52-week-high field from a single vendor.** Oracle at -58.8%, Western Digital at -45.6% and Intel at -38.7% from their highs are the strongest claims in this brief and each rests on one unverified field. The conclusion — that the AI-infrastructure complex has been repriced far harder than the index — is robust across nine names and would survive material error in any one. The individual decimals are not robust.
- **Polymarket odds are thin marks.** The Hormuz normalisation and US-invasion probabilities are market-implied prices from a prediction market with modest liquidity, quoted at second hand through Hedgeye rather than read directly. They indicate direction of sentiment and nothing more.
- **Two calendar items had conflicting reports and are flagged rather than resolved.** One source placed Warsh's Jackson Hole keynote on 29 August against the better-corroborated 28 August, 10:00 ET; and sources split on whether consumer confidence prints 25 or 26 August. Both were verified against multiple named outlets rather than carried forward, and the better-supported reading is used. Nvidia's 26 August date is corroborated by both Hedgeye's own note and independent reporting and is not in doubt.

KNOWN GAPS

- **No band-to-band diff was possible this run**, and this is the most material gap. Hedgeye's Early Look category view does not paginate — requesting page 2 and page 3 returns Monday's note — and the previous edition's archived PDF, which contains Friday's band set, is not readable from this session's file tools. The floor moves, ceiling moves and change in band width are therefore **unknown, not unchanged**. Given the Nasdaq is sitting 0.30% above its floor, whether that floor rose or fell versus Friday is exactly the information that is missing.
- **No second machine price source.** Yahoo Finance rate-limited the container and returned zero of 62 requested series, so there are no independent daily bars for week-on-week context and no automatic reconciliation. Three headline indices and Micron were recovered by hand against press reporting; the remaining 53 instruments are genuinely single-sourced.
- **IGV was not captured**, so the software risk range — one of the house's core long expressions — has no live position computed against its 99.00-106.00 band. This is an omission from the capture universe, not a source failure.
- **Absence of a Hedgeye position change is not evidence there was none.** The MOMO Tracker, Crypto Quant and Chart of the Day did not appear in the feed since the previous edition. These are the publications that routinely carry position changes and are routinely image-based and unreadable when they do appear. Any change communicated through them on Monday would be invisible to this brief.
- **PCE and consumer confidence consensus figures are not printed** because they could not be confirmed from a primary or clearly-attributed source in this run. Printing an unsourced consensus would defeat the purpose of printing consensus at all.
- **Options positioning is inferred, not measured.** No put/call ratio, gamma-exposure estimate, skew reading or open-interest data was retrieved. Section 6 rests on the VIX move, relative volumes against ten-day averages, and attributed commentary — that is inference from price, and it is presented as such.
- **Asian and European cash markets are closed** and their levels here are previous closes, marked as such, 14-16 hours and roughly 6.6 hours old respectively.

TIMING & UNVERIFIED

- **Capture window: 06:07:18 to 06:07:20 GMT+8, 2.1 seconds.** The 10-minute standard was met with four orders of magnitude to spare. No top-up pass was required and no row carries a separate capture time.
- **The run fired on schedule** at 06:07 GMT+8 against a nominal 06:00, a seven-minute offset with one real consequence: Globex had reopened at 06:00 GMT+8 exactly, so futures were live but only seven minutes into a session that had generated no information. Had the run fired before 06:00 the futures rows would have been closed-market settles.
- **Age of rows at capture.** US cash equity closes: **2 hours 7 minutes**. After-hours prints: complete, window closed at 18:00 ET. European closes: roughly **6.6 hours**. Asian closes, the stalest rows in the document: **14 to 16 hours**. Spot FX and metals: live, 67 minutes of session. Futures: live levels, 7 minutes of session. Bitcoin and Ether: live, 22 hours of session.
- **What supersedes what.** Tonight's Early Look, expected around 19:00 GMT+8, replaces every risk range in section 4 — those sixteen bands have roughly thirteen hours of life left. Asian cash opens between 08:00 and 12:15 GMT+8 and will overwrite

section 12's previous-close footnote entirely. Nvidia's results on Wednesday after the US close will reprice most of section 5 and the whole of section 13.

- **Verify live prices before acting on anything in this document.** Nothing here is a recommendation and every level is a snapshot from a two-second window that closed before this brief was written.